The word textile comes from Latin textilis, means "woven", which in turn comes from the Latin verb textere, "to weave". In textile science, however, a textile is finely defined as any product made from fibres. Types of textiles include animal-based material such as wool and silk, plant-based such as linen and cotton and synthetic material such as polyester and rayon. Textiles are often associated with the production of clothing.

Textile fibre is very long in relation to its thickness. The fibre consists of cells arranged in its longitudinal direction. The strength and elasticity of the fibre is dependent on the forces between these cells.

4.2 Manufacturing Of Fibres

Fibres may be classified based on the origin and chemical type as natural fibres and man-made fibres. Table-1 describes the classification of fibres.

4.2.1 Natural Fibres

Natural fibres are taken from plant and animal sources. Cotton, Silk and wool are the most well-known natural fibres. There are several other commonly used natural fibres such as jute, linen and asbestos.

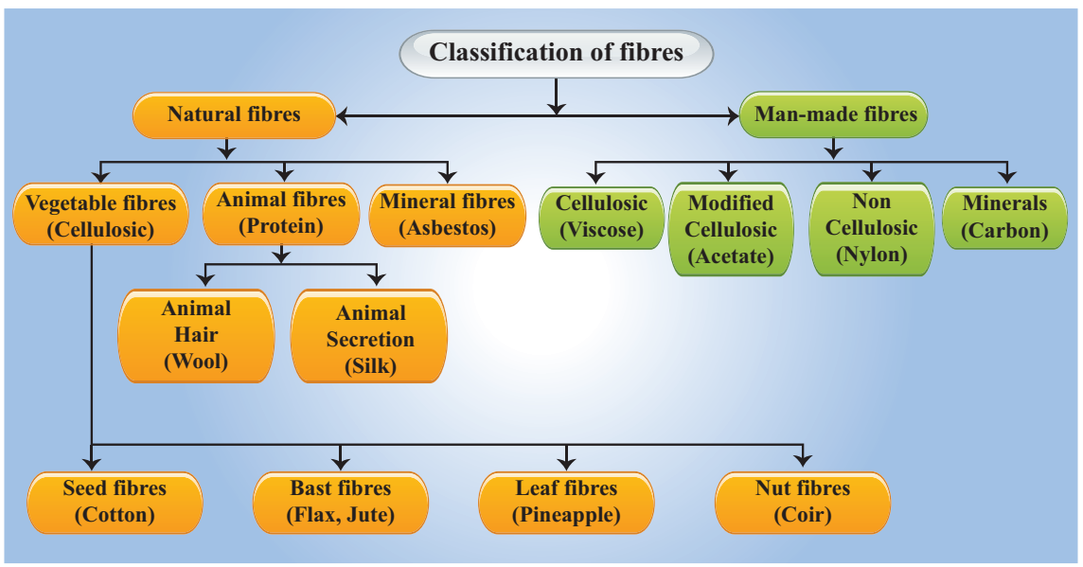
A. Cotton

The word "cotton" is derived from the Arabic word "qoton" or "qutun", which means a plant found in conquered land. Cotton is a fibre that grows on the surrounding surface of seeds in the pods, or balls of a bushy mallow plant. Cotton is referred to as the "**King of fibres**" as it is most important textile fibre in the world.



Cotton plant

The cotton fibre is a long cell- made up of countless cellulose molecules.



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